

MyDesign Portfolio

Element A Initial Template

- 1) Who is involved in this problem?

In this problem, the main things involved would be the rabbits. They play a key role in why we must solve the problem, because they are in need of a habitat. This habitat needs to be not only safe, but a fun place for the rabbits to play in, therefore they are the ones that are mainly involved in the problem.

- 2) What are they doing?

What we are doing is making a rabbit a habitat where it is safer than the original and allow for the caretakers to see them and take them out of the habitat no matter where they are. And a way for the rabbits to have their own place individually and to also make sure the rabbits have it where they can't chew the enclosure/habitat. This way the rabbits have an improved habitat.

- 3) What unique situations does the problem occur within, if any?

The unique situation this problem has is that the rabbits have to be able to be viewed anywhere in the enclosure and that people can pick them up anywhere from the habitat. Another situation is that the new enclosure can't have metal hinges as it can harm the rabbits. Lastly the enclosure has to be able to be taken apart and be put in new ways which gives the rabbits a new thing which allows for them to have new excitement and to have an amazing experience.

- 4) What is the size of the issue?

Pretty large because the rabbits need somewhere to stay and play. Without us building some sort of habitat they would be bored and have nowhere to go and have a safe place to stay.

- 5) Where is the problem happening?

The problem is happening at the Piedmont Wildlife habitat. Piedmont Wildlife Habitat is a non-profit organization encouraging conservation and inspiring people to build lifelong connections with nature.

- 6) When does the problem occur?

When the rabbits play around they may injure themselves with the sharp edges or the metal pieces that keep the boxes together.

Why does the problem happen?

Because a habitat design has yet to help the rabbits. They need a tough structure that can support and protect them. This is not an easy challenge, but it would solve the problem of the rabbits not having a stable play place.

- 7) How is this a big issue?

In the original habitat, staff at the clinic couldn't clean the habitat which could eventually make the rabbits sick or die. There were some metal pieces and sharp edges that would harm the rabbits which could make them unable to play around.

Resources:

- <https://www.earth.com/news/pet-rabbits-need-space-and-freedom-to-play-and-exercise/>
- Kyra Thurow Bartow (kyra@piedmontwildlifecenter.org), Animal Husbandry & Intern Manager, is the client for this project.
- Piedmont Wildlife Center

Stakeholder Concerns and Connections (A3, A4)

Some stakeholders may include:

- Kyra Thurow Bartow (kyra@piedmontwildlifecenter.org), Animal Husbandry & Intern Manager, is the client for this project

Bartow would like for us to make a shelter or habitat for the rabbits that is safe, clean, fun, complex, and lightweight. For example if it's clean for the rabbits the people that will come and adopt the rabbits don't have to worry about if they have been exposed to toxic chemicals that will make them sick.

Problem Importance (A6)

This problem is important because the rabbits deserve a quality way to spend their time. A research conducted by the University of Bristol Veterinary School shows that without proper spacing out, and close confinement rabbits feel a larger amount of stress. Having a place that has proper space and things for the rabbits to play on is also crucial to maintaining a healthy weight.